



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 50

WEST VIRGINIA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside West Virginia's family courts and child-welfare system.

35

WEST VIRGINIA FAMILIES ON RECORD
· 58 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 33
MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF
PARENTING TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 1, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

19 OF 55

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

WEST VIRGINIA AT A GLANCE.

Across 35 West Virginia families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 58 35 of 35 families reported child counts	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$6,250 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 33 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 48.6% 34.3% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 35	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.7	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 35 of 35	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 19

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so West Virginia families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02

THE COST OF WEST VIRGINIA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	20	\$6,250	\$21,754	\$435,080
Lost Wages	13	\$1,000	\$11,798	\$153,380
Other Court Fees	10	\$0	\$402	\$4,020
Therapy / Evaluations	16	\$1,150	\$3,292	\$52,675
Reunification Services	15	\$3	\$1,867	\$28,003
GAL Fees	13	\$0	\$3,677	\$47,801
Asset Loss	14	\$2,600	\$94,657	\$1,325,200
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$11,003	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		33	2.8 yrs
Mean months lost		42	3.5 yrs
Total across all families		1,009	84.1 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · WEST VIRGINIA

Most families documenting in West Virginia are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		19	54%
Case closed: within last 2 years		6	17%
Not provided		5	14%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		4	11%
I was a Child of Family Court or CPS		1	3%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		18	51%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		9	26%
Family Court Only		6	17%
Unknown		2	6%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		11	31%
5 – 10 years		7	20%
3 – 5 years		5	14%
Over 10 years		3	9%
Less than 6 months		3	9%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only		9	26%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)		9	26%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access		8	23%
Children in Foster Care		5	14%
Full Custody		2	6%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Mason		4	11%
Wood		3	9%
Putnam		2	6%
Barbour		2	6%
Upshur		2	6%
Harrison		2	6%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		14	40%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		12	34%
Other: (Short answer)		4	11%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)		1	3%
Foster Care / Termination of Parental Rights (TPR)		1	3%

05 PARENT VOICES — WEST VIRGINIA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable West Virginia comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



The family court has completely destroyed my family. I have been robbed of the right to motherhood and all access to my children over false allegations and abusive systematic procedures.

— JESSI

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Destroyed my entire family. My now adult children have problems from enduring this trauma. My marriage failed because of this. I lost custody of my youngest 2 children to my ex husband, with the assistance of him paying off CPS workers to take my children with no investigation [...]

— WEST VIRGINIA PARENT · AMANDA

MORE VOICES FROM WEST VIRGINIA

Traumatized us my children have been medically neglected and abused since being in state care

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system sealed and silenced us while stripping all of us of our rights and innocence, not just the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court proved that abuse can be rewarded and those who never abuse their kids can be punished. As soon as my children were ordered into the full custody of their father, opposing counsel sent an email offering to return the children if I obtained a “do not prosecute” to [...]

— CRISTY

The system has stole my children's life as my children as me as a good contract mother yrs. They stole our life of church God with my children by assaults retolerations after trying to protect myself and family . Our lives are destroyed by the courts fraud abusive litigations [...]

— INCA

Cps has done nothing but tear my family apart for years. I have severe PTSD and anxiety so badly. My children do too. My youngest child now suffers from an eating disorder. I just want her back home. I will never stop fighting for her.

— CONNIE

Separated and divided the family and alienated me from my kids

— DANIEL

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



*DESTROYED CHILDRENS CHILDHOOD, 13 FOSTER HOMES, AND SEPARATED
Boys. DEEPLY HURT WHOLE FAMILY, WE WILL NEVER LOOK AT FAMILY COURT THE
SAME THEY ARE SAVAGES!*

— GAIL

The system has completely DESTROYED my family. I feel like I have no purpose to live anymore.

— AMBER

The system has destroyed relationships, legacies, holidays, milestones, but it has cost me a beautiful relationship with my sons, one that I had with my father, and he had with his father, and it will affect both of these young men for the rest of their lifetime. I'm not a [...]

— BRANDON

Lied put whatever in reports cussed me n kids n gets by with it

— TAMMY

It ripped my daughters away because my daughter got with a girl at school (a trouble maker) who told her to do this and she could do whatever she wanted. They took my daughters away from me who was my everything. Now I have nothing. I want to give up.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has wrecked my life no doubt but more importantly my children's lives and their futures. These kids are affected for the rest of their lives and will prob never be able to fully trust anyone again. The struggle they've been facing trying to understand why they were [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They put my son through unnecessary stress

— TRACEY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



There was no investigation, only an initial contact with CPS alleging educational neglect, in regards to missing 3rd grade assessment. I explained this was our 3rd grade year and assessment is due by June 30 2026. Heard nothing else from CPS. 3.5 months later sheriff serves me [...]

— MISTI

The system has destroyed my family. They couldn't care less about my daughter. They knew I was unable to fork out all the money I needed to to get proper legal representation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined my life not only my kids but mine after my mom was killed 25 years ago by my stepdad

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Has literally taken my very life

— RACHEL

Ripped my identity of being a MOTHER and turned me into a ghost to my children when I'm all they ever known.! Separated all my children breaking our soul tied bonds.! Took a piece a paper of lies to erase DNA !!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have not only stolen my sense of self but they've robbed me and my husband of creating a bond with our newborn. They have shattered my daughters (6 yr old) trust and emotional health.

— CHELSEA

They have taken my Heart, my soul, my love, my life and stomped it into hell on earth.

— T

Ruined my life health spirit. I am dead inside

— DANIELLE

They have traumatized us, villainized us, and caused us an extreme amount of emotional and mental anguish, while putting me over \$40,000 in credit debt. Took away my precious parenting time and my daughters teen years that we will never get back.

— HEATHER

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

Broken our home, our hearts, our trust in the system. Taken precious time that I will never get back with my child.

— NICOLE

It has broke a good family and had stole my children and would not listen to them so I am afraid if something really bad does happen to them then they won't say anything cause no one listen to them before and makes me scared for them

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has taken over 5% of my childs life with him that I will never get back during a time when his mother needs him the most.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It completely tore my world apart and made me have no hope in the justice system/government!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court system that says God as our witnesses allowed a criminal lawyer defend criminals in family court. The psychological harm and reputation is forever dipped in hell and I'll gladly give up my ticket to upstairs to meet them at its gate in the Gods Court

— KAYLA

29 West Virginia parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 29 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — WEST VIRGINIA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from West Virginia families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

The family court has completely destroyed my family. I have been robbed of the right to motherhood and all access to my children over false allegations and abusive systematic procedures.

— JESSI

Destroyed my entire family. My now adult children have problems from enduring this trauma. My marriage failed because of this. I lost custody of my youngest 2 children to my ex husband, with the assistance of him paying off CPS workers to take my children with no investigation or evidence. Now my youngest 2 boys are without their mother during their teenage years.

— AMANDA

Traumatized us my children have been medically neglected and abused since being in state care

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system sealed and silenced us while stripping all of us of our rights and innocence, not just the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court proved that abuse can be rewarded and those who never abuse their kids can be punished. As soon as my children were ordered into the full custody of their father, opposing counsel sent an email offering to return the children if I obtained a “do not prosecute” to spare the father from the fallout of his crimes. Unable to get that, the smear campaign continued and I am still without my children. The theory of parental alienation is being misused and weaponized in true, substantiated abuse cases. I lost complete faith in our legal system.

— CRISTY

The system has stole my children's life as my children as me as a good contract mother yrs. They stole our life of church God with my children by assaults retolerations after trying to protect myself and family . Our lives are destroyed by the courts fraud abusive litigations Satan cruelty retolerations for money .

— INCA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Cps has done nothing but tear my family apart for years. I have severe ptsd and anxiety so badly. My children do too. My youngest child now suffers from an eating disorder. I just want her back home. I will never stop fighting for her.

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The system has completely DESTROYED my family. I feel like I have no purpose to live anymore.

— AMBER

The system has destroyed relationships, legacies, holidays, milestones, but it has cost me a beautiful relationship with my sons, one that I had with my father, and he had with his father, and it will affect both of these young men for the rest of their lifetime. I'm not a perfect man, and I have made mistakes and I have reacted to some situations that I have been put in in not the best way, but I have never jeopardize my son safety I have always thought about the best interest of my son's future, their financial longevity, their success in business and in relationships and family and growth. I've went from a hero to a zero on the sidelines cheering, my son, being a part of every minute to being ripped away like a villain, no arrest, The physical and Dangerman just false allegations, small town good old boy, clubs, and manipulation by a system. That is the biggest Ponzi scheme money making garbage I've ever had the disgust to experience in my 38 years on this earth. This place is where dreams go to die!!

— BRANDON

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has wrecked my life no doubt but more importantly my children's lives and their futures. These kids are affected for the rest of their lives and will prob never be able to fully trust anyone again. The struggle they've been facing trying to understand why they were taken from their loving home and been allowed 0 contact with their mother since has done unimaginable irreversible damage and pain to these innocent babies and their parents. This corrupt system lies everyday to every one of us, starting with them stating that they are "for the kids". They are for no child, they're for their pockets and that is all. Thats the truth and it is horrifying.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— MISTI

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— KAYLA

29 full approved West Virginia comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this West Virginia report comes from West Virginia respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in West Virginia — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 35 West Virginia families reporting here are not the universe of West Virginia families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 5 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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